

## THE GARAMUT



## A MESSAGE SENDER

## *Ps Barry's* *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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## MINISTERING OUT OF OUR NEED

### OUR SUBJECT:

THE BIBLICAL PRINCIPLE OF GIVING OUT OF OUR NEED, GIVING OUT OF OUR POVERTY.

### IT'S ABOUT:

- MINISTERING TO OTHERS IN NEED WHEN WE OURSELVES ARE ALSO IN NEED.
- LEARNING TO MINISTER, SERVE AND TO GIVE REGARDLESS OF THE EVENTS OR CIRCUMSTANCES THAT WE MAY BE PERSONALLY EXPERIENCING.
- TO MINISTER AND SERVE OTHERS OUT OF OUR SUFFERING, PAIN AND SORRY.
- PRAYING FOR THE SICK EVEN WHEN WE ARE NOT WELL OR SICK OURSELVES.
- LEARNING TO SPEAK ENCOURAGEMENT AND LIFTING UP OTHERS WHEN WE OURSELVES MIGHT BE DISCOURAGED OR DISAPPOINTED.
- URGING OURSELVES TO TALK TO SOMEONE WHO IS LONELY AND WITHDRAWN WHEN WE ARE WANTING OUR OWN SPACE TO REFLECT AND WORK THROUGH SIMILAR ISSUES.

### LOVING ONE ANOTHER IS THE FULFILLING OF THE LAW???

- COMING ALONGSIDE OF SOMEONE WHO IS WEAK, STRUGGLING, FEELING INADEQUATE AND VULNERABLE AT A TIME WHEN WE ARE HAVING MOMENTS OF SIMILAR FEELINGS.
- LEARNING TO MINISTER TO THE FINANCIAL AND MATERIAL NEEDS OF OTHERS EVEN WHEN WE ARE IN NEED.

### THE RESULTING BENEFITS:

- ✳ IN REACHING OUT TO OTHERS REGARDLESS OF THE EVENTS AND EMOTIONAL FEELINGS THAT WE MAY HAVE, OFTEN RESULTS IN OURSELVES BEING HELPED, STRENGTHENED, UPLIFTED AND EVEN HEALED.
- ✳ I HAVE PROVED THIS TO BE TRUE ON MANY OCCASSIONS
- ✳ IT IS IN OUR ACTUALLY ENGAGING IN THIS KIND OF ACTIVITY THAT WE ARE ALSO MINISTERED TO.

### EXAMPLES

*Proverbs 11:25 Whoever brings blessing will be enriched, and one who waters will himself be watered. ESV*

- ✳ Whoever waters (that blesses, uplifts etc) others is in turn blessed and uplifted by God and by someone.

*Proverbs 19:17 Whoever is generous to the poor lends to the Lord, and he will repay him for his deed. ESV*

- ✳ If we are generous towards the poor – it is like lending to the Lord and he always pays what he owes.

*Proverbs 22:9 Whoever has a bountiful eye will be blessed, for he shares his bread with the poor. ESV*

- ✳ A bountiful eye is someone who has an attitude that seeks the good of others and directly connects attitude with action.

- ✳ It is an eye (heart attitude) that looks to share riches with others and is the result of purposeful action and not prompted by some event or experience encountered.

#### DID YOU KNOW?

- \* THAT IN OUR ENCOURAGING OTHERS, WE ALSO ARE STRENGTHENED AND ENCOURAGED.
- \* THAT IN OUR PRAYING FOR THE SICK WE SOMETIMES EXPERIENCE HEALING OURSELVES.
- \* THAT IN OUR MINISTERING TO THOSE WHO ARE POOR WHEN WE OURSELVES ARE IN NEED OF HELP OPENS THE DOOR FOR GOD TO MINISTER TO OUR NEED.

#### THE POOR WIDOW'S EXAMPLE

- \* THIS SAME PRINCIPLE IS ALSO CLEARLY SEEN IN THE ACCOUNT THAT JESUS SPOKE OF CONCERNING THE ACTIONS OF A POOR WIDOW IN HER GIVING TO GOD.
- \* HER QUALITY OF GIVING EXEMPLIFIES THE PRINCIPLE OF GIVING OUT OF POVERTY.
- \* THAT WE AS BELIEVERS ARE EXPECTED TO GIVE OUT, TO MINISTER TO OTHERS EVEN IF WE ARE POOR AND IN NEED OF HELP. - (E.G. Poor in spirit, Poor financially etc)

*Luke 21:1-4 - He also saw a poor widow put in two very small copper coins. "Truly I tell you," he said, "this poor widow has put in more than all the others. All these people gave their gifts out of their wealth; but she out of her poverty put in all she had to live on." NIV*

- \* IT MEANS GIVING OUT TO OTHERS REGARDLESS OF WHAT WE MIGHT BE FACING, (Personally or Ministry wise)
- \* THIS WOMEN SHE SETS FORTH A REQUIRED ACTION FOR ALL BELIEVERS TO FOLLOW AND BE PROACTIVE ABOUT.

#### NOTE:

- \* OTHERS GAVE OUT OF THEIR WEALTH, THEIR ABUNDANCE. THEIR SURPLUS, BUT, THIS WIDOW, GAVE OUT OF HER POVERTY
- \* SHE GAVE OUT OF HER NEED, HER LACK AND HER WANT,

*Luke 21:4 ..*

- *But she out of her poverty put in all she had to live on." NIV*
- *She has contributed out of her lack and her want, AMP*
- *She, even out of her need, has put in all her living. BBE*

*Luke 21:4 For they gave out of their wealth, having more than enough for themselves: but she, even out of her need, has put in all her living. BBE*

#### JESUS ALSO PRACTICED THIS PRINCIPLE.

**Example.** IN HIS HOUR OF EXTREME SUFFERING AND ANGUISH HE STILL REACHED OUT TO ONE OF THE CRUCIFIED THIEVES.

*Luke 23:42-43*

*42 Then he said, "Jesus, remember me when you come into your kingdom."*

*43 Jesus answered him, "I tell you the truth, today you will be with me in paradise." NIV*

- \* EVEN THOUGH JESUS WAS HATED, CRITICISED AND PEOPLE SOUGHT TO KILL HIM HE CONTINUED TO LOVE, HEAL, FORGIVE AND TO DO GOOD TO PEOPLE.

#### THE MACEDONIAN CHURCH ALSO PRACTICED THIS PRINCIPLE.

- \* THIS PRINCIPLE WAS THE UNDERLYING FACTOR FOR THEIR GENEROUS ACTIONS TOWARDS THE SUFFERING BRETHREN IN JERUSALEM.

#### THEIR PERSECUTION AND POVERTY.

- \* The Christians in the Macedonian churches were experiencing great affliction and ill treatment being persecuted for their faith which resulted in extreme poverty.
- \* Yet, they were able to be abounded in their liberality towards others and as a result they experienced abundance of joy in the midst of their tribulation.
- \* THEY GAVE OUT OF THEIR LITTLE, while trusting in God to provide for them, and make it up to them.

YES, THIS WAS THE TESTIMONY OF THE CHURCH THAT IN THE MIDST OF THEM FACING TRIBULATION AND DEEP POVERTY – AND BECAUSE THEY WERE WILLING TO DO WHAT GOD SAYS ABOUT GIVING – IT RESULTED IN AN OVERFLOWING WEALTH OF LAVISH GENEROSITY ON THEIR PART.

THEIR ACTION OF FIRST GIVING OF THEMSELVES TO GOD WAS EXPRESSING THEIR WILLINGNESS TO DO WHAT GOD HAD SAID ABOUT MINISTERING TO OTHERS OUT OF THEIR OWN RESOURCES.